

Station 4: Phone

Tripod and gimbal operation, then a walking selfie video and a walking video tracking someone else. Try the wireless mic.

Where your shots go: The walking selfie, the tracking walk on the gimbal, the same walk handheld, and the two mic clips, to the class image channel.

Terms to master

Term	In one line
Lock	Freezing exposure, focus, and white balance so the phone stops re-deciding them mid-shot. AE/AF/WB lock.
Tripod	Three legs and a head that hold the camera still and at the height you chose, so the frame stops moving and you can step away.
Gimbal	A motorized handle that keeps a phone or camera level and steady while you move, smoothing out rotation, not footsteps.
Stabilization	Ways of steadying a shot: optical (the lens element moves), electronic (the frame is cropped and shifted), or mechanical (a gimbal or tripod).
Front vs. rear camera	The rear camera is the good one: bigger sensor, better lens, more modes. The front camera is the one you can see yourself in.
Manual camera app	A phone camera app that exposes the controls the built-in app hides: ISO, shutter, white balance, focus, and format, and lets you lock them.
Computational photography	What a phone does to an image before you ever see it: stacking frames, guessing depth, brightening faces, flattening contrast. The camera as an interpreter.
Wireless mic	A small transmitter with a mic on it that sends sound to a receiver plugged into your phone or camera, so the mic can be on the person, not on the camera.

Gear: your phone, the tripod / selfie stick you're being given, the DJI Osmo Mobile gimbal, a wireless mic set, headphones, Blackmagic Camera installed (free, iPhone and Android).

Recipe

Part one: the tripod.

1. Unfold the tripod you're keeping and mount the phone. Eye level, rear camera, an arm's length away. Lock the head. Frame yourself with your eyes a third of the way down. Then extend it as a stick: a high shot over the table, a low shot along the floor.

Part two: the gimbal.

1. Mount the phone on the gimbal, balance it, power on, and let it level. Try the modes: pan-follow (the default), lock, and the trigger (hold to lock, double-tap to recenter).
2. **Walking selfie.** Front camera on the gimbal, arm out, walk and talk for fifteen seconds. Bend your knees; the gimbal takes out the wobble, not the bounce.
3. **Tracking someone else.** Rear camera. Follow a classmate or a group as they walk across the studio: walk beside them, then behind them, then let them walk toward you. Keep them on a third. Fifteen seconds each.

4. **The comparison.** Do the tracking walk once more handheld, no gimbal, and send both.

Part three: the mic.

1. Plug the wireless receiver into the phone. Turn on the transmitter and wait for the link light. Open the camera app and confirm it's recording from the receiver (scratch the transmitter mic and listen). Clip it 6–8 in below your chin, record two sentences, then record them again with the phone's own mic at arm's length. Play both on headphones.

If there's time.

1. Open Blackmagic Camera, point at the lit subject from station 1, and lock exposure, focus, and white balance. Compare the same face in the stock app, which flattens the lighting back toward normal.

Notice

The gimbal removes rotation, not your footsteps. Walking beside, behind, and toward are three different shots of the same walk. Distance to the mic beats everything else about the mic.